

There used to be a Chief Election Commissioner only in the Election Commission of India. Two additional Commissioners were appointed to the Election Commission on October 16, 1989, but they served only up to January 1, 1990. Again two, additional Election Commissioners were appointed on October 1, 1993 and since then, the Commission had three members.

58. Who among the following was not the member of Election Commission of India?

- (a) Dr. M.S. Gill (b) N.B. Lohani
(c) T.S. Krishnamurti (d) B. Lyngdoh

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000 (*)

Ans. (b)

M.S. Gill was the Chief Election Commissioner in 2000 while T.S. Krishnamurti and J.M. Lyngdoh were the other election commissioners. Later Krishnamurti and Lyngdoh also became the Chief Election Commissioner.

59. Consider the facts given below:

- Sukumar Sen was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India.**
- Rama Devi was the first woman Chief Election Commissioner of India.**

Choose the correct answer from the codes given below.

Codes:

- (a) Only 1 is correct
(b) Only 2 is correct
(c) Both 1 and 2 are correct
(d) Both 1 and 2 are incorrect

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

Former Karnataka and Himachal Pradesh Governor V. S. Ramadevi was the only woman to head the Election Commission. Sukumar Sen (2 January 1898 -13 May 1963) was an Indian civil servant who was the first Chief Election Commissioner of India, serving from 21 March 1950 to 19 December 1958.

60. Who was the first women to become a Chief Election Commissioner of India?

- (a) R.M. Nikam (b) S.K. Bedi
(c) V.S. Ramadevi (d) G.D. Das

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

V.S. Ramadevi was the first woman to become the chief election commissioner of India in 1990. Sukumar Sen was first chief Election Commissioner of India from 1950 to 1958.

61. Which one of the following is the “National Voters’ Day”?

- (a) 5th June (b) 1st November
(c) 25th January (d) 8th March

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

To encourage young voters to take part in the political process, the Government of India has decided to celebrate January 25 every year as ‘National Voters Day.’ It was started from January 25, 2011 to mark the commission’s foundation day.

62. National Voters Day is celebrated on -

- (a) 15th January (b) 25th January
(c) 17th January (d) 27th January

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

Political Parties

*The Party system is a part of the political system. *Formation and working of the government in the Democratic political system is done with the help of the Party system. ***Under the Representation of the People Act 1951**, there is a provision for the registration of political parties. *Election commission registers the Political Parties. *By 52nd Constitutional Amendment Act 1985, Political Parties, for the first time, were given the Constitutional status. This Act came into force on 1 March, 1985. ***Tenth schedule** which is related to **Anti-defection** law, was added in Indian Constitution by the **52nd constitutional Amendment Act 1985**.

*Internal party democracy is used for internal election in the political parties. *It occurs periodically to elect the officials of the political parties.

*The Election Commission is empowered to grant status to different political parties as national and state parties.

*Presently **6 political parties** are recognised as **National-level parties** in our country. *These are **Indian National Congress (INC), Bhartiya Janta Party (BJP), Bahujan Samaj Party, Communist Party of India - Marxist (CPI-M/CPM), Aam Aadmi Party** and **National People’s Party**.

*In India, elections are held on the basis of Universal Adult Franchise. *Political parties have the freedom to establish their own standard. *The Indian National congress was founded in 1885 and its first president was W.C. Banerjee. *The word 'National' in Indian National congress is against the reaction of British Rule.

*Bharatiya Janta Party was founded in 1980 and its first president was Atal Bihari Vajpayee.

***The Independent Labour party** was founded by Dr. B.R. Ambedkar in 1936. *The Communist Party of India was founded in 1925 and C.P.I. (Marxist) was founded in 1964.

1. Consider the following statements regarding the political parties in India:

1. **The Representation of the People Act, 1951 provides for the registration of political parties**
2. **Registration of political parties is carried out by the Election Commission**
3. **A National level political party is one which is recognized in four or more states**
4. **During 1999 general elections, there were six National and 48 State level parties recognized by the Election Commission**

Which of the statement above are correct?

- (a) 1, 2 and 4 (b) 1 and 3
(c) 2 and 4 (d) 1, 2, 3 and 4

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (d)

The Representation of the People Act, 1951 provides for the registration of political parties. The registration of political parties is carried out by the Election Commission of India. The Election Commission has decided that a political party shall be eligible to be recognized as a National party if –

(i) It secures at least six percent (6%) of the valid votes polled in any four or more states at general election to the House of People (Lok Sabha) or to the State Legislative Assembly (Rajya Vidhan Sabha) and wins at least four seats in the House of People from any State or States, or it wins at least two percent (2%) seats in the House of People (i.e., 11 seats in the existing House having 543 members), and these members should be elected from at least three different States. Currently, there are 6 national political parties in India.

2. Who is empowered to recognize various political parties in India as National or Regional Parties?

- (a) The Parliament (b) The President
(c) The Election Commission (d) The Supreme Court

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

The Election Commission accords recognition to political parties as National or State Parties in accordance with the norms laid down in the Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968.

3. Who recognises the political parties in India?

- (a) President of India
(b) Election Commission of India
(c) Ministry of Law and Justice
(d) Speaker of Lok Sabha

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

The Election Commission of India provides recognition to the political parties in India. The Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, provides for the recognition of political parties.

4. Political parties in India are registered and recognised by which of the following?

- (a) The Respective Election Commission of States
(b) The Elections Commission of India
(c) The Law Commission of India
(d) The Law Ministry of Government of India

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

5. A party gets recognition as a national party when –

- (a) It gets 5% of total votes.
(b) It contests election in all constituencies.
(c) It receives power in more than four States.
(d) It receives 5% of the votes in four States.

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (*)

A political party gets recognized as a National Party by the Election Commission if it fulfils any of the three following conditions:

- (1) If the party wins 2 percent of seats in the Lok Sabha from at least three different States; or
- (2) In Lok Sabha or Legislative Assembly, the party secures 6 percent of the total valid votes in at least four States, and it wins at least four seats in the House of the People from any State or States; or
- (3) A party has got recognition as a State party in at least four or more States.

6. To be recognized as National Party in India, a party must have secured at least how much percentage of votes in the previous election ?

- (a) At least 10 percent of valid votes in four or more States
(b) At least 4 percent of valid votes in four or more States
(c) At least 15 percent of valid votes in four or more States

- (d) At least 6 percent of valid votes in more than half of the States
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) (Re- Exam), 2020

Ans. (e)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. A political party in India can be recognized as National Party if it has state party status in at least:

- (a) Three states (b) Four states
(c) Five states (d) Seven states

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

See the explanation of the above question.

8. A political party is recognized as a regional party, if

- (a) It gets 4% votes in the State either in Lok Sabha or the Assembly election.
(b) It gets 6% votes in the State either in Lok Sabha or the Assembly election.
(c) It gets 8% votes in the State either in Lok Sabha or the Assembly election.
(d) None of the above.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (c)

According to the Amendment of Election Symbols (Reservation and Allotment) Order, 1968, a party has to live up to at least one of the following qualifications to be acknowledged as a State party-

- (1) If the party wins at least 3 seats or 3% of the seats whichever is greater, in the State Legislative Assembly; or
- (2) If it wins a minimum 1 seat in the Lok Sabha for every 25 seats or any fraction allotted to that concerned State; or
- (3) If the party wins Lok Sabha seat with 6 percent of valid votes in the latest Lok Sabha elections or 2 Vidhan Sabha (Legislative Assembly) seats with 6 percent of valid votes in the latest state assembly election; or
- (4) The status of a State party can still be bestowed upon an entity even if it fails to win any seats in the Lok Sabha or the Assembly, if it manages to win at least 8% of the total votes cast in the entire State. Thus, this is clear that the most suitable option is (c) but U.P.P.S.C has mentioned option (d) as the correct answer in their answer key which is incorrect.

9. A party can be recognised as a State Party when:

- (i) it secures 6% of the total valid votes polled in the state at a general election to the Legislative Assembly of the state concerned.
 - (ii) it wins 2 Assembly seats at a general election to the Legislative Assembly of the state concerned.
 - (iii) it secures 4% of the total valid votes polled in the state at a general election to the Lok Sabha of the state concerned.
 - (iv) it secures 6% of the total valid votes polled in the state at a general election to the Lok Sabha of the state concerned.
- (a) Only (i) or (iii)
(b) Only (i) or (iv)
(c) Only (i) and (ii)
(d) None (i) and (ii)

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of above the question.

10. The word 'National' in Indian National Congress was influenced by-

- (a) Ancient Indian precedents
(b) Reaction against British rule
(c) European Precedents
(d) Freedom struggle of America

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

The word 'National' in Indian National Congress was influenced by the reaction against British rule.

11. The Nationalist Congress Party was formed in 1999 following the split in

- (a) Shiv Sena
(b) Congress Party
(c) BJP
(d) BSP

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

The NCP was formed on June 10, 1999 by Sharad Pawar, P. A. Sangma, and Tariq Anwar after they were expelled from the Indian National Congress (INC), following the dispute relating to Sonia Gandhi's foreign origin.

12. Which of the following political parties is/are national political parties?

1. Muslims League
2. Revolutionary Socialist Party
3. All India Forward Block
4. Peasants and Workers Party of India

Code :

- (a) 1, 2 and 3 (b) 2 and 4
(c) 3 only (d) None of these

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (d)

Currently, there are a total 6 parties in India which satisfy the condition for being a National Party. These are- Bhartiya Janata Party(BJP), Indian National Congress(INC), Bahujan Samaj Party (BSP), Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), Communist Party of India (Marxist) (CPI (M)), and National People's Party. Out of the given political parties, no political party satisfies the condition for being a National Party. Thus, option (d) is the correct answer.

13. Which one of the following has been recognised as National Party in 2016?

- (a) I.N.L.D. (b) Akali Dal
(c) T.M.C. (d) A.I.A.D.M.K.

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (c)

On 2 September, 2016 the Election Commission provided the national party status to the Trinamool Congress Party (All India Trinamool Congress). Currently, India has six recognised national parties. But in current scenario TMC is not National Party.

14. After the formation of Bharatiya Janata Party, who became its first President?

- (a) L.K. Advani
(b) A.B. Vajpayee
(c) M.M. Joshi
(d) Sikandar Bakht

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

Atal Bihari Vajpayee became the first President of Bhartiya Janata Party in 1980. **Shyama Prasad Mukherjee (1901-1953)** was the **Founder of the Bharatiya Jana Sangh**. The BJP is the successor Party of the Bhartiya Jan Sangh.

15. Which of the following political parties is not a national party as recognized by the Election Commission of India-

- (a) Nationalist Congress Party
(b) Bahujan Samaj Party
(c) Communist Party of India
(d) Samajwadi Party

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Samajwadi Party is not a national party recognized by the Election Commission of India. Samajwadi Party came into existence on October 4, 1992 in Lucknow under the leadership of Mulayam Singh Yadav.

16. Which of the following is a Regional Political party?

- (a) Congress (b) BJP
(c) CPI (d) Akali Dal

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Akali Dal (Shiromani Akali Dal) is a regional political party of Punjab.

17. Which one of the following parties is not a National Political Party?

- (a) Communist Party of India
(b) Bhartiya Janata Party
(c) Telugu Desham
(d) Indian National Congress

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (c)

Telugu Desham Party (TDP) is a regional party of Andhra Pradesh.

18. Aam Aadmi party is a :

- (a) State party
(b) National Party
(c) Regional party
(d) Registered party
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

The Aam Aadmi Party was a state level registered party, as all Political Parties are registered. So, it is also a registered party. Hence, option (e) is the appropriate answer. But in current scenario the Aam Aadmi Party is national party.

19. Who was the founder of 'Independent Labour Party'?

- (a) R.Srinivasan
- (b) B.R. Ambedkar
- (c) C. Rajagopalachari
- (d) Lala Lajpat Roy

U.P. Lower sub. (Pre) 2009

Ans. (b)

The Independent Labour Party (ILP) was an Indian political organization formed under the leadership of Dr. B. R. Ambedkar in August 1936.

20. Which of the following parties were formed by Dr. B. R. Ambedkar?

- 1. The Peasants and Workers Party of India
- 2. All India Scheduled Castes Federation
- 3. The Independent Labour Party.

Select the correct answer from the codes given below:

- (a) 1 & 2 Only
- (b) 2 & 3 Only
- (c) 1 & 3 Only
- (d) 1, 2 & 3

I.A.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (b)

Dr. Ambedkar founded Samata Sainik Dal, the Independent Labour Party (1936), the Scheduled Castes Federation (1942) and the Depressed Classes Federation (1930). The Peasants and Workers Party of India was founded in 1948 in Maharashtra. It was a Marxist Political party. While the Workers and Peasants Party (PWP) was founded on November 1, 1925 by Kazi Nazrul Islam, Hemant Sarkar, Shamsuddin Hussain and Qutubuddin Ahmad. It was not founded by Dr. Ambedkar. It worked under the Indian National Congress during 1925 to 1929.

21. Consider the following pairs :

	Party	Its Leader
1.	Bharatiya Jana Sangh	Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee
2.	Socialist Party	C. Rajagopalachari
3.	Congress for Democracy	Jagjivan Ram
4.	Swatantra Party	Acharya Narendra Dev

How many of the above are correctly matched?

- (a) Only one
- (b) Only two
- (c) Only three
- (d) All four

I.A.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (b)

Dr. Shyama Prasad Mukherjee founded the Bharatiya Jana Sangh in 1951 and he became the first President of it. So, pair 1 is correctly matched.

Jai Prakash Narayan, Ram Manohar Lohia, and Acharya Narendra Dev were prominent leaders of the Socialist Party while C. Rajagopalachari was the founder leader of the Swatantra Party, not the Socialist Party. So, pairs 2 and 4 are not correctly matched.

The political party Congress for Democracy (CFD) was founded in 1977 by Jagjivan Ram. So, pair 3 is correctly matched.

Hence, option (b) is the correct answer.

22. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer by using the code given below the lists:

List-I (Political Party)	List-II (Year of Formation)
A. CPI	1. 1972
B. CPM	2. 1920
C. AIADMK	3. 1964
D. Telugu Desham	4. 1982

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	2	3	1	4
(b)	3	2	4	1
(c)	1	2	3	4
(d)	4	1	3	2

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2011

Ans. (a)

The matched list is as follows-

(Political Party)	(Year of Formation)
CPI	- 1920
CPM	- 1964
AIADMK	- 1972
Telugu Desham	- 1982

Note : The Communist Party of India was established on 17 October, 1920 at Tashkent. In India, the CPI was founded in 1925 in Kanpur (now in Uttar Pradesh State). As per the given option the correct answer is option (a).

23. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the codes given below the lists:

List-I (Political Parties)	List-II (Year)
A. Indian National Congress	1. 1951
B. Bhartiya Jan Sangh	2. 1972
C. Communist Party of India	3. 1885
D. A.I.A.D.M.K.	4. 1925

Codes :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	1	4	2
(b)	2	3	4	1
(c)	4	3	2	1
(d)	2	1	4	3

U.P.R.O/A.R.O. (Mains) 2017

Ans. (a)

The correct match of List I with List II is as follows :

Political Parties	Year
Indian National Congress -	1885
Bhartiya Jan Sangha -	1951
Communist Party of India -	1925
A.I.A.D.M.K. -	1972

24. In which year was the Communist Party of India divided into two parties- CPI and CPI (M)?

- (a) 1962 (b) 1964
(c) 1966 (d) 1969

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2014

Ans. (b)

The Communist Party of India was divided into two parties CPI and CPI(M) in 1964 when a faction of the members of the Communist Party of India (CPI) broke away from it.

25. Match the following political parties listed in List-I with their years of establishment in List-II :

List—I (Political Parties)	List—II (Years of Establishment)
A. Communist Party of India (Marxist)	1. 1964
B. Communist Party of India	2. 1998
C. Bahujan Samaj Party	3. 1925
D. All India Trinamool Congress (AITC)	4. 1984

Select the correct answer using the codes given below.

	A	B	C	D
(a)	1	3	4	2
(b)	2	1	4	3
(c)	2	1	3	4
(d)	3	4	1	2

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

The correct match is following –

Political Parties	Years of Establishment
Communist Party of India (Marxist)	1964
Communist Party of India	1925
Bahujan Samaj Party	1984
All India Trinamool Congress (AITC)	1998

26. Consider the following Political Parties and arrange them in the chronological order of their establishment.

I. Bahujan Samaj Party

II. Samajwadi Party

III. Telugu Desham Party

IV. All India Trinamool Congress

Select the correct answer from the code given below.

Code :

- (a) II, I, III, IV (b) I, II, III, IV
(c) III, I, II, IV (d) III, II, I, IV

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

Political Parties in India		
Name	Abbreviation	Founding Date
1. Bharatiya Janata Party	BJP	6 April 1980
2. Indian National Congress	INC	28 December 1885
3. Communist Party of India (Marxist)	CPI-M	7 November 1964
4. Communist Party of India	CPI	26 December 1925
5. Bahujan Samaj Party	BSP	14 April 1984
6. Nationalist Congress Party	NCP	10 June 1999
7. All India Trinamool Congress	AITC	1 January 1998
8. National People's Party	NPP	6 January 2013
9. Samajwadi Party	SP	1992
10. Telugu Desam Party	TDP	1982

27. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer from the code given below the lists.

List – I (Trade Unions)	List – II (Party Affiliation)
A. Bhartiya Majdoor Sangh	1. Indian National Congress

- B. Indian National Trade Union Congress
C. United Trade Union Congress
D. All India Trade Union Congress
2. Communist Party of India
3. Communist Party of India (Marxist)
4. Bhartiya Janta Party

Code :

	A	B	C	D
(a)	3	2	1	4
(b)	4	1	3	2
(c)	2	4	3	1
(d)	1	3	2	4

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (*)

(Trade Unions)	(Party Affiliation)
Bhartiya Majdoor Sangh (BMS)	— Bhartiya Janta Party
Indian National Trade Union Congress (INTUC)	— Indian National Congress
United Trade Union Congress (UTUC)	— Revolutionary Socialist Party
All India Trade Union Congress (AITUC)	— Communist Party of India

28. Which of the following Parties were not a part of the United Front which was in power during 1996-1997?

1. Bahujan Samaj Party
2. Haryana Vikas Party
3. Samata Party
4. Asam Gana Parishad

Select the correct answer using the code given below:

Code :

- (a) 1, 2, 3 and 4 (b) 1, 2 and 3
(c) 3 and 4 (d) 1 and 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

Bahujan Samaj Party, Samata Party, and Haryana Vikas Party were not a part of the United Front Government during 1996-97.

29. Given below is the Vote percentage secured by a political party in three successive elections to the Lok Sabha. The party which secured these percentages of votes was-

Year	1984	1989	1991
Percentage of Votes	7.4	11.4	22.4

The party to receive above-mentioned percentage of votes was-

- (a) Congress (I)
(b) Bahujan Samaj Party
(c) Bhartiya Janata Party
(d) Communist Party of India (Marxist)

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

The above-mentioned percentage of votes is of Bhartiya Janata Party.

30. Consider the following statements and identify the correct answer from the codes given below :

- (1) The Congress won 145 Lok Sabha seats in 2004 election.
(2) The BJP won 133 Lok Sabha seats in 2004 election.
(3) The CPI(M) won 48 Lok Sabha seats in 2004 election.

Codes :

- (a) Only (1) is Correct.
(b) Only (1) and (2) are correct.
(c) Only (2) and (3) are correct.
(d) Only (1) and (3) are correct.
(e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2024

Ans. (a)

According to the data of Election Commission of India, in the General Elections, 2004 (14th Lok Sabha) the Indian National Congress won 145 seats; the BJP won 138 seats and the CPM [CPI(M)] won 43 seats. Hence, statement 1 is correct, while statements 2 and 3 are incorrect.

31. Given below is a list of political parties along with seats won by them in the election to thirteenth Lok Sabha. Which one of these is not correctly matched?

- (a) CPM-32 (b) TDP-30
(c) BJD-10 (d) BSP-14

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

In 13th Lok Sabha T.D.P (Telugu Desham Party) won only 29 Seats, therefore option (b) is not correctly matched.
C.P.M in 13th Lok Sabha- 32 seats.
T.D.P in 13th Lok Sabha - 29 seats.
B.S.P in 13th Lok Sabha - 14 seats.
B.J.D 13th Lok Sabha -10 seats.

32. Consider the following statements :

(i) The Lok Sabha Elections of 1989 marked the end of, what Political Scientists have called, the 'Congress System'.

(ii) Indian National Congress emerged as the single largest party in the 1989 Lok Sabha Elections.

- (a) Neither (i) nor (ii) is correct.
- (b) Both (i) and (ii) are correct.
- (c) Only (ii) is correct.
- (d) Only (i) is correct.
- (e) Question not attempted

Raj. P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

General elections were held in India in November 1989 to elect the members of the 9th Lok Sabha. In the 1989 General Elections, Congress bagged the highest number of seats (197 seats) in the Lok Sabha, but the numbers were not enough for it to form a government of its own. A coalition government was formed by the Janata Dal with outside support from BJP and the left parties Vishwanath Pratap Singh became the Prime Minister. Thus, the elections of 1989 marked the end of what political scientists called the 'Congress System'.

33. Consider the following statements –

Assertion (A) : The coalition government led by Bharatiya Janata Party contains some policy guidance in the National agenda, some promises and few guiding principles for its governance.

Reason (R) : It discusses a lot of things in detail. Which one of the following is correct in context to above statements.

Codes :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but, (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but, (R) is true.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Pre) 1998

Ans. (b)

Coalition Governments may contain many parties. As a result, the Government has to take care of the feelings of all the parties included in the Government. Thus, (R) and (A) both are correct but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A)

34. In which of the following state a regional party is not in power?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Andhra Pradesh
- (c) Jammu and Kashmir
- (d) Kerala

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

In Kerala, the Government by Congress or the Communist Party of India(Marxist) has been formed alternatively. Both of these parties are national parties. Under Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019, the then Jammu and Kashmir has been divided into two Union Territories namely Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh. So, at present Jammu and Kashmir is not a state.

35. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other labelled as Reason (R):

Assertion (A) : In India, the political parties which formed the governments represented the majority of seats secured in the elections to the House of the People at the Centre and the Legislative Assemblies in the States but not the majority of votes.

Reason (R) : The result of elections based on the majority-vote-system is decided on the basis of the relative majority of votes secured.

In the context of the above two statements which one of the following is correct?

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but, (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but, (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Here both (A) and (R) are true and (R) is the correct explanation of (A), because in India majority does not depend upon the majority of votes but on the majority of seats. Election of winning candidates depends upon a relative majority of votes and not on the total majority of votes.

36. Given below are two statements, one labelled as Assertion (A) and the other labelled as Reason (R).

Assertion (A) : The reservation of thirty-three percent of seats for women in Parliament and State Legislature does not require a Constitutional amendment.

Reason (R) : Political parties contesting elections can allocate thirty-three percent of seats they contest to women candidates without any Constitutional amendment.

In the context of the above two statements which one of the following is correct?

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true but, (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false but, (R) is true.

I.A.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Article 330 to 334 of the Indian Constitution provisions for the reservation of some special classes in the House of People and State Legislative Assemblies. There is no provision made for women; thus the reservation of 33% of seats for women in the Parliament and State Legislature can be made only by the Constitutional Amendment. So, Assertion (A) is incorrect while the Reason (R) is correct.

37. Consider the following statements:

Assertion (A) : There is no fixed party system in India.

Reason (R) : There are too many political parties. Select the correct answer from code given below:

Code:

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A).
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not a correct explanation of (A).

(c) (A) is true but, (R) is false.

(d) (A) is false but, (R) is true.

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2004

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (a)

Democracy in India is passing through a period of transition. Casteism and regionalism are still the dominating elements in India. Various political parties are formed by the regional leaders to meet various interests, but this is not the only reason behind having multi-party system in India. There are other socio-economic reasons which are also affecting the party system in India.

38. The party system is the part of which larger system among the following?

- (a) Social system
- (b) Economic system
- (c) Political system
- (d) International system

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2012

Ans. (c)

The Party system is the part of the political system. The formation and running of the Government in a democratic political system is performed by party system (Political Parties).

39. Study the following statements and select the correct answer from the code given below:

Assertion (A) : India has a written Constitution.

Reason (R) : Growth of strong regional parties is an indicator of regional aspirations.

Code :

- (a) Both (A) and (R) are true, and (R) is the correct explanation of (A)
- (b) Both (A) and (R) are true, but (R) is not the correct explanation of (A).
- (c) (A) is true, but (R) is false.
- (d) (A) is false, but (R) is true.

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) (Re. Exam) 2015

Ans. (b)

India has a written Constitution. Thus Assertion (A) is correct. Strong regional parties grow to meet regional aspirations. These regional parties raise the problems of the region and stress on increasing the facilities of that region. As a result the regional public diverts towards them. Thus, Reason (R) is also correct. But the reason (R) is not the correct explanation of the Assertion (A).

40. Which of the following may be considered a Pressure Group?

- (a) Members of the Lok Sabha
- (b) Members of a Panchayat
- (c) Members of the Cabinet
- (d) Members of a Trade Union

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

A pressure group can be described as an organised group that does not put up candidates for election, but seeks to influence government policy or legislation. These groups can also be described as 'interest groups', 'lobby groups' etc. Trade Union, Farmer's Organisation, Women Organisations, Business organisation etc are included in pressure groups.

41. Inner-Party Democracy stands for –

- (a) A Government formed by several parties with a common programme
- (b) Party closest to the party or parties forming the Government
- (c) Periodical elections within the party to elect the office bearers of the party
- (d) Secrets of Government are shared by parties in power

U.P. Lower Sub. (Spl) (Pre) 2004

Ans. (c)

Inner-Party democracy stands for periodical elections within the party to elect the office bearers of the party.

42. Who among the following scholars described the party system prevailing in India in the early years of Independence as one party dominant system?

- (a) Myron Weiner
- (b) Rajni Kothari
- (c) Austin
- (d) Bhikhu Parikh

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2016

Ans. (b)

Rajni Kothari has described the party system prevailing in India in the early years of Independence as one party dominant system. Rajni Kothari was a political scientist and writer. Kothari noted works include 'Politics in India', 'Caste in Indian Politics' and 'Rethinking Democracy'.

43. What was the date when the Anti-defection Bill was passed?

- (a) 17 February, 1985
- (b) 15 February, 1985

(c) 30 March, 1985

(d) 21 April, 1985

U.P. P.C.S. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (b)

The Anti-Defection Law was passed by the Parliament on 15 February, 1985 and came into force on 1st March, 1985. The 52nd amendment to the Constitution by amending Article 101, 102, 190 and 191 and adding the 10th Schedule laid down the process by which member of House may be disqualified on the grounds of defection.

44. Which one of the following is not covered by the Anti-Defection Law?

- (a) An-bloc defections in a Party.
- (b) Large defections in a Party in various spell.
- (c) Smaller defection in a single spell.
- (d) Party members in Parliament casting vote either to topple or support a Government.

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (b)

The 10th Schedule to the Constitution, popularly known as the Anti-Defection Law, introduced by the Constitution (52nd Amendment) Act, 1985 laid down the process by which the member of a political party may be disqualified on the grounds of defection. It makes provisions for an-bloc defection in a party, smaller defection in a single spell and party members in the Parliament casting vote or support a government. Larger defections in a party in various spell are not provided under this law.

45. The political parties got the Constitutional recognition for the first time in the year –

- (a) 1975
- (b) 1977
- (c) 1985
- (d) 1995

U.P.P.C.S. (Mains) 2010

Ans. (c)

The political parties got the Constitutional recognition for the first time in 1985 by the Constitution when the 10th Schedule was added to the Constitution to curb defection.

46. The merger of a political party with another political party in India is recognised in which of the following conditions?

- (a) When not less than one-third members of the legislature party have agreed to such merger.
- (b) When not less than half members of the legislature party have agreed to such merger.

- (c) When not less than two-third members of the legislature party have agreed to such merger.
- (d) When not less than three-fourth members of the legislature party have agreed to such merger.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

If a member goes out of his party as a result of a merger of the party with another party. A merger takes place when two-third of the members of the party have agreed to such a merger. Therefore, option (c) is correct.

47. With reference to anti-defection law in India, consider the following statements:

1. The law specifies that a nominated legislator cannot join any political party within six months of being appointed to the House.
2. The law does not provide any time-frame within which the presiding officer has to decide a defection case.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) 1 only (b) 2 only
- (c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

I.A.S. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

The Tenth Schedule, popularly known as the Anti-Defection Law, was included in the Constitution via the 52nd Amendment Act, 1985. This law specifies that a nominated legislator cannot join any political party after six months of being appointed to the house. If they join any political party after six months, then that legislator can be disqualified. The law does not provide any time-frame within which the presiding officer has to decide a defection case. Thus only, second statement is correct.

48. Which of the following is not true about the Anti-Defection Bill?

- (a) An M.P. or an M.L.A. will be disqualified if he has voluntarily given up the membership of the party to which he belonged.
- (b) In the event of a member's absence from voting in the House on a particular issue, an M.P. or M.L.A. will be disqualified.

- (c) A member shall not be disqualified if there is a merger of political parties.
- (d) The Speaker of the Lok Sabha will not be disqualified if he becomes a member of another political party later on.

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

According to the provisions of Anti-defection Laws provided in 10th Schedule of the Indian Constitution, the Speaker of Lok Sabha before the election as a member of a party if he voluntarily leaves his membership and does not rejoin that party until he serves on that post cannot be disqualified. But if he becomes the member of any other party, then he may be disqualified. Thus, option (d) is incorrect.

49. A member of State Legislature/Parliament is considered an exception of disqualification on the ground of defection in India, in which of the following condition?

- (a) If he voluntarily, gives up the membership of his original political party on being elected as Chairman or Vice-Chairman of any house of State Legislature or of Parliament.
- (b) If he re-joins the political party after he ceases to hold such office.
- (c) In both of these
- (d) In none of these

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (c)

If a member, after being elected as the presiding officer of the house, voluntarily gives up the membership of his party or rejoins it after he ceases to hold that office. This exemption has been provided in view of the dignity and impartiality of this office.

Therefore it is considered an exception of disqualification on the ground of defection in India. So option, (c) is the correct answer.

50. The Anti-Defection Law was enacted as early as 1979 in-

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Jammu and Kashmir
- (c) West Bengal
- (d) Tamil Nadu

I.A.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (b)

Legislative Assembly of Jammu and Kashmir in 1979 passed the 'Anti-Defection Law.' According to its provision, if any Member of the Legislative Assembly leaves his party, then he shall not remain a member of the Legislative Assembly.

51. Consider the table given below providing some details of the results of the election to the Karnataka State Legislative Assembly held in December, 1994.

Political Party	Percentage of Popular Votes obtained	Number of Seats secured
Janta Dal	36	116
Congress	31	35
BJP	20.4	40

In terms of electoral analysis, the voter-seat distortion is to be explained as the result of the adoption of the :

- (a) Hare system
- (b) Cumulative vote system
- (c) First-past-the post system
- (d) Plural vote system

I.A.S. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (c)

First-past-the-post system is a method in which a member is considered elected on the basis the highest received votes. There is no importance of percentage of the total votes under this system. In India, the system is quite popular in State Legislative Assemblies and House of the People.

52. To be officially recognized by the Speaker of Lok Sabha as an Opposition Group, a party or coalition of parties must have at least-

- (a) 50 members
- (b) 60 Members
- (c) 80 Members
- (d) 1/3 of total members of the Lok Sabha

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (*)

The number of members of the opposition party required to be recognized as the Party in opposition is at least $\frac{1}{10}$ th (54.3 members) of the total membership (total members-543) of the Lok Sabha. According to the "rules and tradition" of the Indian Parliament, the Party in opposition must have at least 54 seats in the Lok Sabha to rightfully gain and claim the mantle of the opposition party.

53. In which State Communist parties jointly launched "Bhu-Poratam" Movement?

- (a) Andhra Pradesh
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) Kerala

R.A.S./R.T.S.(Pre) 2007

Ans. (a)

The 'Bhu Poratam' movement (struggle for land) was organised by the Bharatiya Khet Mazdoor Union (BKMU) (one of the communist parties) in Andhra Pradesh to demand agricultural lands and House sites for landless agricultural workers. The name 'Bhu-Poratam' was given by the Communist parties.

54. Which of the following does not constitute the social base of the communist party in India?

- (a) Agriculture and Industrial working class
- (b) Business class
- (c) The educated
- (d) Youth

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (b)

Business class does not constitute the social base of the Communist Party in India. The Communist Party opposes capitalism while the business class supports of capitalism. Thus, this class does not constitute the social base of this party.

55. The principle of 'Kamaraj Plan' was-

- (a) To Establish an ideal socialist society
- (b) Industrial Development of Tamil Nadu
- (c) Making Indian National Congress Vibrant
- (d) Promotion of cooperative farming

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (c)

'Kamaraj Plan' was prepared in 1963 by K. Kamaraj, then the President of the Indian National Congress. This plan was prepared to make the Indian National Congress vibrant.

56. Consider following statements about Electoral Bond Scheme 2018:

- (A) The aim of this scheme is to bring about transparency in the funding process of political parties.